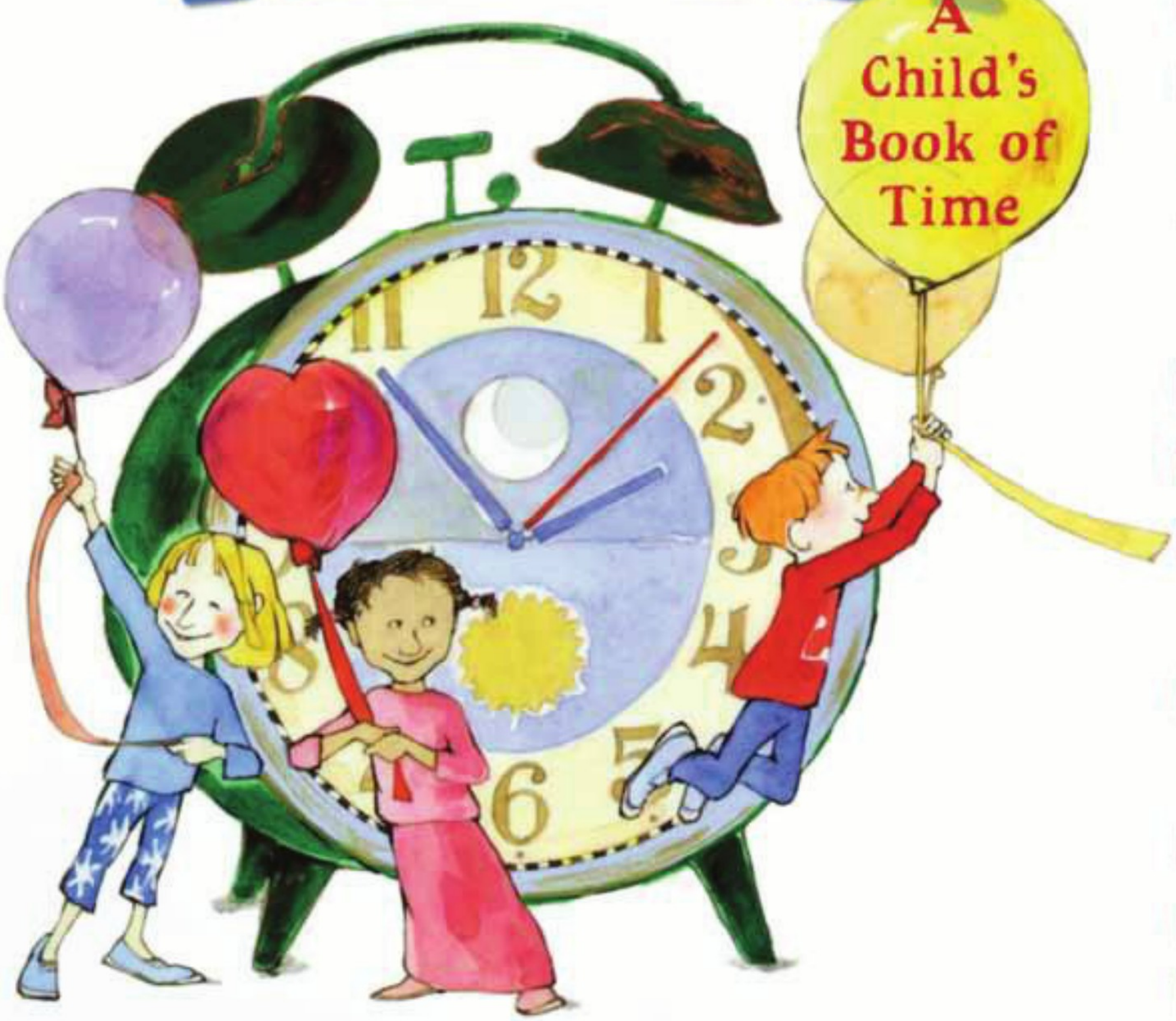
A SECOND IS A HICCUP

A Child's Book of Time



by HAZEL HUTCHINS

Illustrated by KADY MACDONALD DENTON

Mc Graw Hill

Modeling Concepts of Print

- Flip through the book and point out that many left-side pages start with a question set in special type, and these questions announce the next unit of time.
- Explain that this book is a poem, and that poems sometimes have capital letters at the beginning of lines that are not sentences.
- Point out that not all of the lines begin at the left side of the page. Explain that poems often feature text that is placed in special ways.

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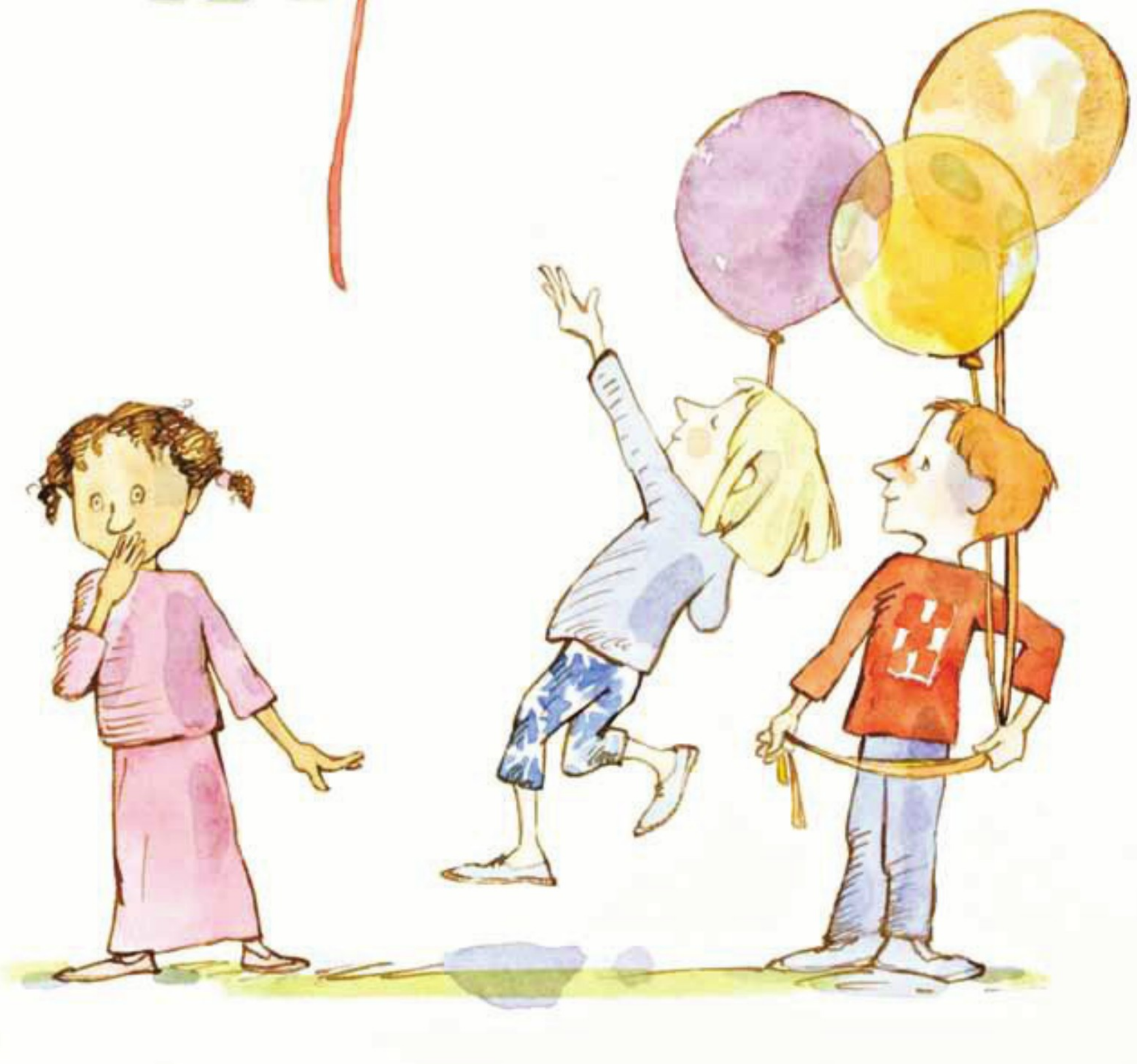
A SECOND IS

A Child's Book of Time

by Hazel Hutchins

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Kady MacDonald Denton

A HICCUP





How long is a second?



A second is a hiccup—

The time it takes to kiss your mom



Or jump a rope
Or turn around.



How long is a minute?

Sixty seconds to a minute,
Sixty hiccups, sixty hops.

Or if you sing just one small song
Chorus, verses, not too long



That's just enough to fill
A minute.



How long is an hour?

Sixty minutes singing by.
If you build a sandy tower





Run right through a sprinkly shower
Climb a tree and smell a flower
Pretend you have a secret power
That should nicely fill
An hour.



How long is a day?

Twenty-four hours by the clock.
Starting when the sun comes up
A day needs filling, like a cup
Hiccups, kisses, songs and showers
Lots of trees and lots of flowers





Breakfast, lunch and snack and dinner
Play some games and cheer the winner
Draw a picture, read a book
Tell a joke and learn to cook
Watch the sunshine fade away
Fall asleep, and that's a day!



How long is a week?

Seven days all in a line.
Sunday Monday Tuesday Wednesday
Thursday Friday and the end day
Saturday—a favorite one!
Some are quiet, some are fun.











Work days, home days, play days, school days







Seven wake-ups, seven sleeps



Close your eyes and do not peek
But you'd never
Ever ever
Stay asleep for one whole week.





How long is a month?

Four weeks add up to form a month.
Lots of time for things to change
Seasons often rearrange





Winters melt and warm to springs
Caterpillars find their wings
And if you fall and scrape a shin
In a month there's brand-new skin





Learn to tie your laces tight



Learn to float, relaxed and light



Learn to count clean up to ten
Learn to count back down again

Watch the moon grow round and fat
Then thin again, imagine that!
And all of it in one month flat.



How long is a year?

Twelve months together make a year.
A great big circle spinning round
Climb aboard, you're one year bound



You'll grow right out of your old shoes
And taller too—now that's good news!





Sunshine, snow and rain and squall





Winter, spring, summer, fall



Twigs on trees grow leaves and peaches



See how far a whole year reaches





Tiny babies learn to walk
Bigger babies learn to talk
Holidays of every kind
Linked together in a line



When your birthday's almost here,
You are older
By a year!

Changes come and changes go
Round and round the years you'll grow



Till you're bigger, till you're bolder
Till you're ever so much older.



And through all the hours and days
As time unfolds in all its ways
You will be loved—



As surely as
A second is a hiccup.









For the great-grandchildren
of Peggy and Bill Sadler,
a delightful, ever-growing circle.
— H. H.

For Eila. — K. M. D.

Respond to Reading

Show the Big Book and prompt children to retell the story in their own words.

Ask children:

- What did you learn from this book?
- What are some activities described in the book that can be done in a second? A month?
- Why is this book called *A Second Is a Hiccup*?
- What are the shortest and longest units of time described in this book?

About the Author: Hazel Hutchins

Hazel Hutchins has always lived in Alberta, Canada—on a prairie farm, on a horse ranch, in Calgary, and now in a small, mountain town. She has more than 40 books published in five countries and has won many awards in Canada and beyond.

About the Illustrator: Kady MacDonald Denton

Kady MacDonald Denton studied fine art and architecture. She works up in the attic of her home in Ontario, Canada. Her illustrations have won many awards. Before becoming a children's book author and illustrator, she worked as a city planner and a costume designer for theater in Toronto.



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